

Beatle bites the Apple thrice

The Beatles record label company—Apple Corps Ltd—has sued Apple Computer Inc for the third time over, promoting music using the name 'Apple'.

Apple Corps sued Apple Computer the first time in 1990, over the misuse of their name and the logo to promote digital music software. Apple Computer paid US \$26.4 million, and signed an agreement to not offer music products. The second time, the lawsuit

was regarding Mac's ability to manage music content through the attached speakers, which was a supposed violation of the agreement between them.

This time, the Beatles claim that the launching of the iTunes service was a breach of agreement. Apple Computer has also been advertising the new iPod as being from Apple-Music. The iTunes Music Store has been exceptionally successful in selling music online. Apple Computer has sold more than 10 million songs through it, at 99 cents each.



snapshot

The number of active Web sites running on **Windows Server 2003** has grown to about **185,000**—an increase of **109** per cent since **July 2003**

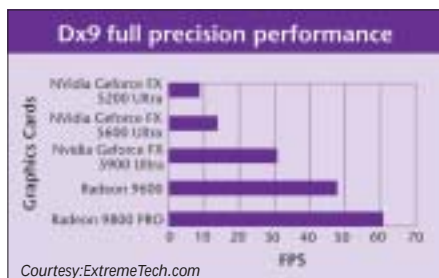
Source: Netcraft

ATi zooms past nVidia

According to recent test results by Valve Software, the developers of *Half Life 2*, the ATI Radeon 9800 Pro was found to be about twice as fast as the nVidia GeForceFX 5900

Ultra in the high-end section. In the price to performance category, the Radeon 9600 Pro was about three times faster.

In February 2003, when FutureMark conducted tests using its 3DMark03, the GeForce Ti 4600 scored less than the 2000 mark, while the Radeon 9700 Pro breached



the 4500 mark. This caused nVidia to initiate a public relations campaign aimed at undermining 3DMark03's credibility as a benchmark.

Now, rumours are rife that *Half-Life 2* will be offered as part of the ATi card-software discounted deal at the game's launch.

Good morning, Bucharest

Rising costs and cultural Raffinity may make Eastern Europe in general, and Romania in particular, very attractive for outsourcing operations.

Being geographically, and hence culturally closer to western Europe, French, German, British and Dutch com-

panies are now setting up their operations there. Others are moving further east to Romania, where human resources are available at even lower costs. Though India is perceived as getting increasingly expensive, it may be a long while before eastern Europe is threatens India's position.



Sharp 3D Notebooks

Sharp is to launch a notebook at the end of October 2003 that is capable of displaying 3D images. Priced at around US \$3,000 (Rs 1,50,000), the 2.8 GHz, Pentium 4-based, Mebius PC-RD3D comes with a 15-inch display, and has an nVidia GeForce4 Go 440 graphics controller. A parallax barrier between two LCD panels generates a slightly different image for each eye, which the brain merges into a single 3D image. No special glasses are needed to view these images.

The 3D and 2D mode can be interchanged, thus allowing it to act as a normal 2D monitor as well.

Sharp will be shipping the basic 3D content creation and viewer tools with the notebook, and is expecting software developers to come up with plug-ins for their applications and games to support it. Currently, Dynamic Digital Depth Inc, is providing 3D content to Sharp. Sharp has also taken the lead in establishing a 3D consortium, which now has 142 members.

heroes

Anti-virus software Norton AntiVirus has sold more than 120,000 units, making it the top business software in terms of sales.

Sophos had a good year as well, with profits going up by 24 per cent to £12.1m.

Though this does mean a good time for the developers, it is only due to increasing threat of worms such as W32.Blaster.

DirectX 9

Microsoft hails *Half-Life 2* as the new benchmark for DirectX 9-based games. *Half-Life 2* is being developed by Valve Software, and is being made ground up by their in-house game engine, Source. The game is touted to deliver a new dimension in game graphics.

zeroes

Microsoft

After pushing the release date back twice, Microsoft declined to give out the shipping date of Longhorn, the company's most significant upgrade to Windows. Unfortunately, PCI-X—the replacement for the aging PCI standard—will be ready next year, and will have no software support unless Microsoft builds something into Windows XP.

ISO

The Geneva-based International Standards Organisation (ISO) has proposed a royalty fee on the ISO standards, which implies that all the companies selling an ISO-compliant product will have to pay a fee. Organisations such as the World Wide Web Consortium (W3C) and Unicode are opposing this proposal.